

MEMORANDUM

To: Nick Menhart, Vice Provost for Accreditation and Assessment
File, Illinois Tech, Programmatic Academic Assessment

From: Edward Harris, Chicago-Kent College of Law (PAC for JD program assessment)

Date: September 16, 2025

Re: Academic Assessment of *Juris Doctor* Program for AY 2024-2025

As discussed at length between the Vice Provost for Accreditation and Assessment and the assessment coordinator for Chicago-Kent's *juris doctor* (JD) program, the university has waived the requirement for the law school to submit an annual assessment report for the JD program for the current year i.e., assessment covering AY 2024-2025 to be submitted by October 15, 2025. The reasons for the waiver of this year's assessment report submission requirement are as follows:

1. Like many states across the United States, Illinois has recently adopted a new and different format for its state bar examination, the passage of which is required to earn licensure to practice law in the state. The new and different format of the bar examination, called the "NextGen Bar Exam," will likely involve significant curricular changes to the JD program at most U.S. law schools, including Chicago-Kent. Both the curricular changes and an increased emphasis on legal skills in the NextGen bar exam will thus likely require substantial revision to our existing learning outcomes and performance indicators used to assess the JD program. Chicago-Kent's Curriculum Committee is currently in the process of analyzing the JD curriculum and the potential changes it may need to make in light of the requirements of the NextGen bar exam. At some point during this process, the Curriculum Committee will also examine and revise the assessment plan for the JD program with new or modified learning outcomes and performance indicators for the JD program which are in line with the revised JD curriculum and the requirements of the NextGen bar exam.
2. The law school will also use the waiver period to revise its assessment method to bring it into further alignment with best practices in assessment by including student artifacts in the underlying data supporting the conclusions reached in a programmatic academic assessment of the JD program. Further discussions between Illinois Tech's Vice Provost for Accreditation and Assessment and Chicago-

Kent's Curriculum Committee and other relevant faculty are to take place early in the fall 2025 semester to determine the practical aspects of integrating student artifacts into the annual assessment process, i.e., to identify and resolve any conflicts or issues with the law school's tandem obligation to assess the JD program per the American Bar Association's programmatic academic assessment requirements and any other issues or conflicts with unique or idiosyncratic aspects of legal education.

The understanding between the law school and the Vice Provost for Accreditation and Assessment is that the law school will undertake the analysis and implementation of curricular changes and the consequential revisions to the assessment procedure for the JD program during the current academic year, 2025-2026, with the goal of being in a position to resume regular annual assessment of the JD program by summer 2026.